

CDAC FUTURE SKILLS PROGRAMME

Demystifying Android Application Security

Day 02 – Assignment: Android Static Analysis

JADX, APKTool and MobSF – Standard Practical Tasks

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Task 0 – APK Identification

Item	Value
Filename	InsecureShop.apk
File size	4,754,534 bytes (~4.54 MB)
SHA-256	a83298ae4a37fcab8101e8b41e513dd2199af71a94ea537d556a318e07d4d1bd
Analysis date	23-09-2026

Part A – Manual Static Analysis (JADX and APKTool)

Task 1 – JADX: APK & Class Identification

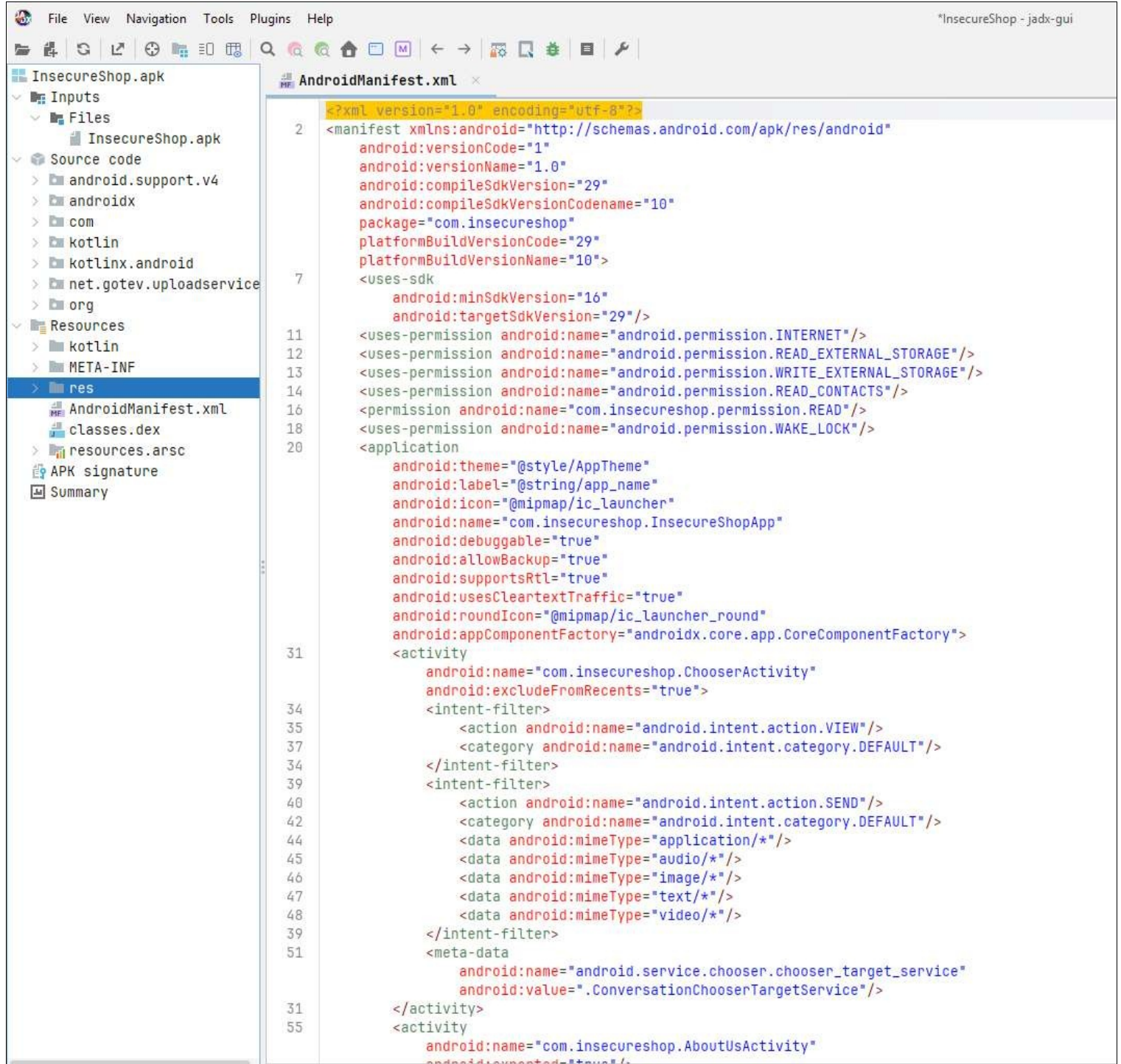
Objective: To decompile the provided APK using JADX-GUI and identify its package name, main activity, and one security-relevant class.

Item	Observation
APK	InsecureShop.apk
Package name	com.inseureshop
Main/Launcher Activity	com.inseureshop.ProductListActivity
Security-relevant class	com.inseureshop.LoginActivity
Tool	JADX-GUI

JADX-GUI was used to decompile **InsecureShop.apk** and inspect its package structure and source code. The package name was identified as `com.inseureshop`. `ProductListActivity` was identified as the main launcher activity from the **MAIN** and **LAUNCHER** intent-filter. `LoginActivity` was selected as a security-relevant class because it handles user authentication/login functionality.

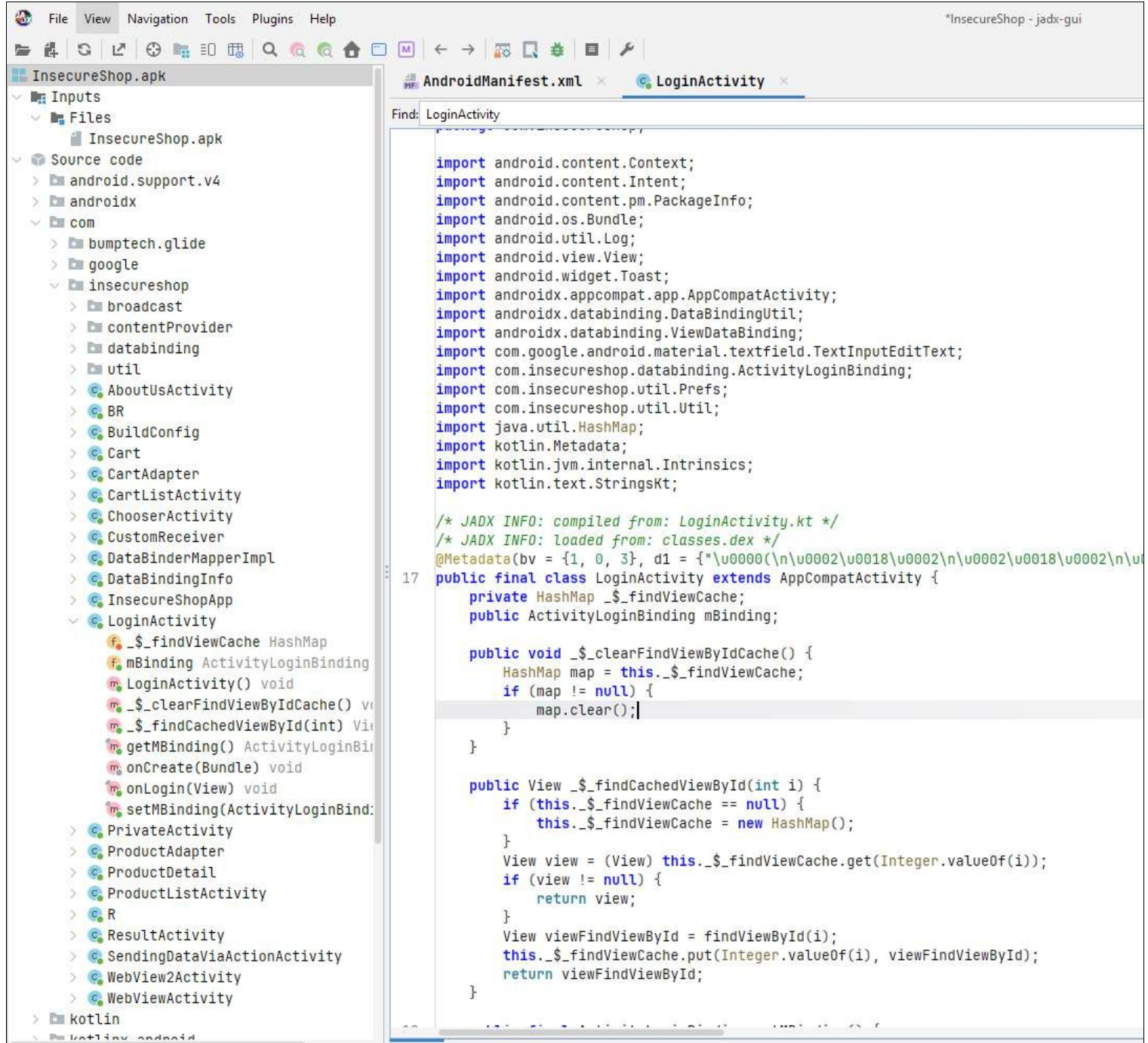
Screenshot 1

JADX manifest view showing the InsecureShop package name and launcher activity.



Screenshot 2

JADX decompiled source showing the security-relevant LoginActivity class.



Task 2 – Keyword Search in Decompiled Source

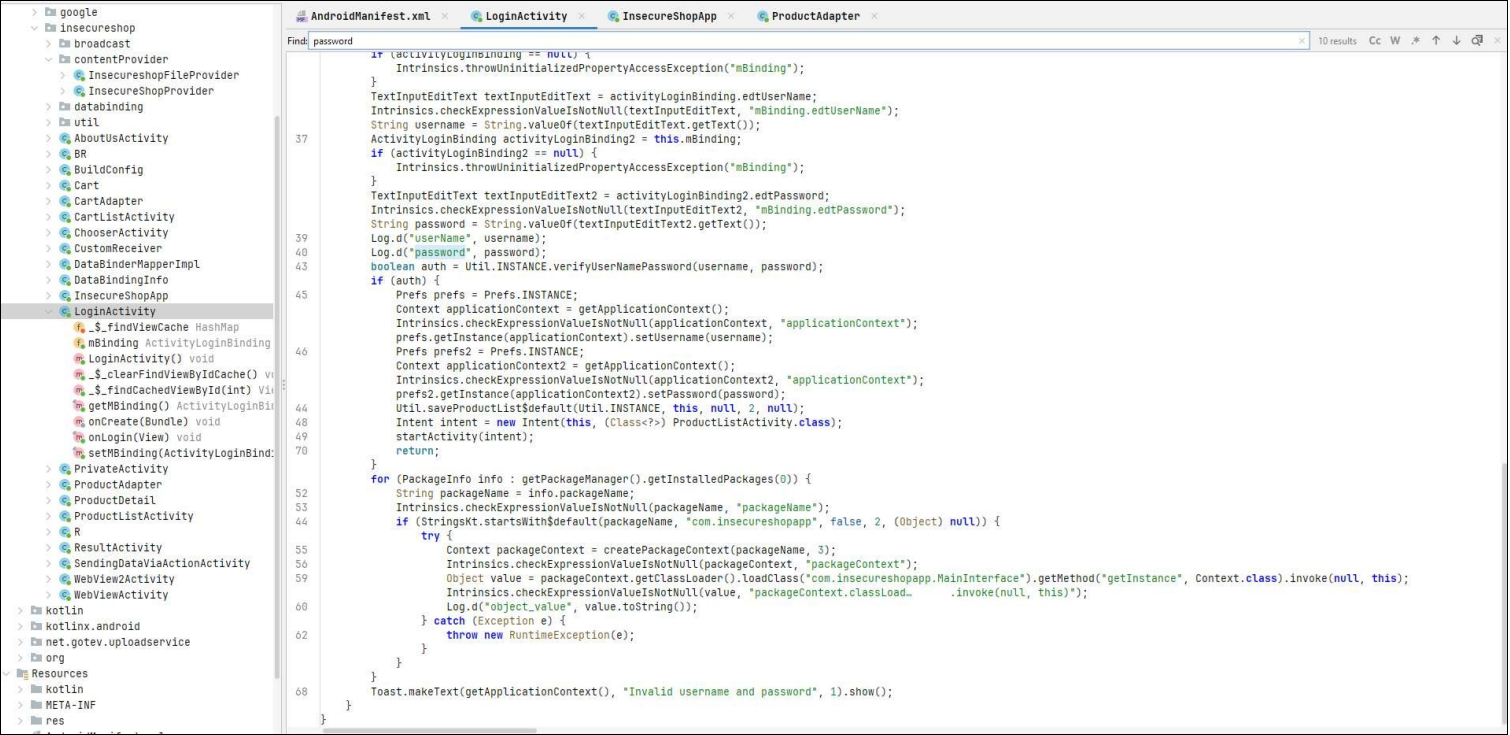
Objective: To search the decompiled project for security-relevant keywords using JADX (Ctrl+Shift+F) and identify genuinely relevant results.

Result 1: LoginActivity

Keyword search for **password** in `LoginActivity` located the `onLogin()` method, which retrieves the password from the input field, passes it to the authentication function, and also writes it to the Android debug log using `Log.d("password", password)`. The password is subsequently passed to `setPassword(password)`. These operations are security-relevant because they involve handling and logging/storing authentication credentials.

Screenshot 1

LoginActivity opened in JADX with the `onLogin()` method visible.

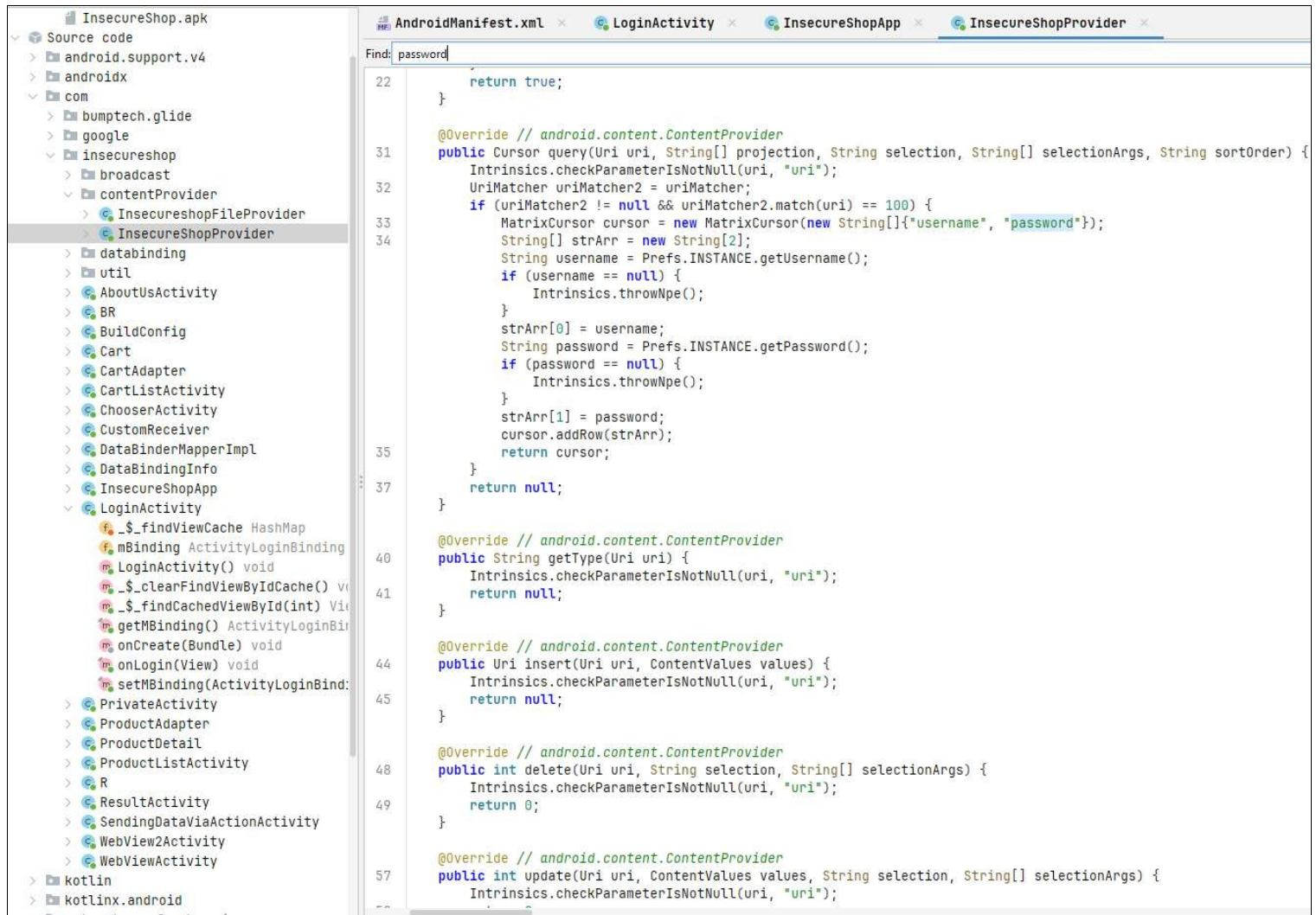


Result 2: InsecureShopProvider

Keyword search for **password** in `InsecureShopProvider` located the `query()` method, which retrieves the stored username and password via `Prefs` and places both values into a returned `MatrixCursor`. This is security-relevant because the class is a `ContentProvider` handling and returning credential data.

Screenshot 2

InsecureShopProvider opened in JADX with the `query()` method visible.



Task 2 – Keyword Search Table

Keyword	Class	Method	Security-relevant observation
password	LoginActivity	onLogin()	Password is retrieved, logged with Log.d(), and passed to setPassword().
password	InsecureShopProvider	query()	Stored username and password are retrieved and placed into a returned Cursor.

Task 3 – APKTool Decoding

Objective: To decode the APK using APKTool and inspect the resulting Android application structure.

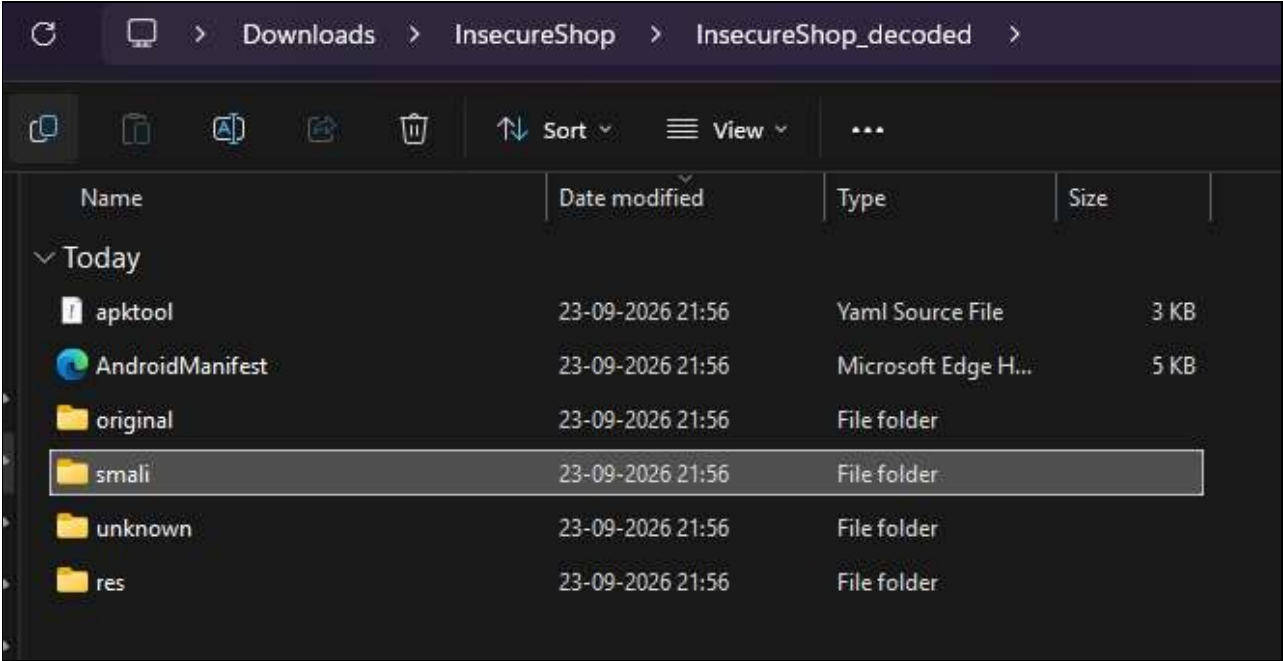
Command:

```
.\apktool.bat d InsecureShop.apk -o InsecureShop_decoded
```

Observation: APKTool 3.0.3 successfully decoded `InsecureShop.apk`. The decoded application directory was created as `InsecureShop_decoded`. The APKTool output confirmed decoding of the resource table, `classes.dex`, resources, and `AndroidManifest.xml`. The decoded folder contained **AndroidManifest.xml**, **res/**, and **smali/** as expected.

Screenshot 1

File Explorer showing the InsecureShop_decoded folder containing AndroidManifest.xml, res, and smali.



Screenshot 2

PowerShell terminal showing the apktool decode command and the directory listing before/after decoding.

```
PS C:\Users\KUDSIT\Downloads\InsecureShop> dir
```

```
Directory: C:\Users\KUDSIT\Downloads\InsecureShop
```

Mode	LastWriteTime		Length	Name
----	-----		-----	----
-a-----	23-09-2026	21:55	48	apktool.bat
-a-----	23-09-2026	21:53	15478013	apktool_3.0.3.jar
-a-----	23-09-2026	21:12	4754534	InsecureShop.apk

```
PS C:\Users\KUDSIT\Downloads\InsecureShop> .\apktool.bat d InsecureShop.apk -o InsecureShop_decoded
I: Using Apktool 3.0.3 on InsecureShop.apk with 8 threads
I: Loading resource table...
I: Baksmaling classes.dex...
I: Decoding value resources...
I: Loading resource table from file: C:\Users\KUDSIT\AppData\Local\apktool\framework\1.apk
I: Decoding file resources...
I: Generating values XMLs...
I: Decoding AndroidManifest.xml with resources...
I: Copying original files...
I: Copying unknown files...
PS C:\Users\KUDSIT\Downloads\InsecureShop> dir
```

```
Directory: C:\Users\KUDSIT\Downloads\InsecureShop
```

Mode	LastWriteTime		Length	Name
----	-----		-----	----
d-----	23-09-2026	21:56		InsecureShop_decoded
-a-----	23-09-2026	21:55	48	apktool.bat
-a-----	23-09-2026	21:53	15478013	apktool_3.0.3.jar
-a-----	23-09-2026	21:12	4754534	InsecureShop.apk

Task 4 – AndroidManifest.xml Security Review

Objective: To inspect the decoded AndroidManifest.xml for security-relevant application settings, exported components, and permissions.

1. Security Flags

Setting	Value	Observation
android:debuggable	true	Debugging is enabled
android:allowBackup	true	Application data backup is allowed
android:usesCleartextTraffic	true	Cleartext HTTP traffic is permitted
android:networkSecurityConfig	Not observed	No custom network security configuration declared

These configurations were recorded as **security-relevant configurations** and were not treated as confirmed vulnerabilities at this stage.

2. Exported Components

Component	Exported	Observation
ChooserActivity	Not explicitly declared	Has intent filters
AboutUsActivity	true	Explicitly exported
CartListActivity	Not explicitly declared	No exported attribute
ProductListActivity	Not explicitly declared	Has MAIN/LAUNCHER
LoginActivity	Not explicitly declared	No exported attribute
WebViewActivity	Not explicitly declared	Has VIEW/BROWSABLE intent filter
WebView2Activity	Not explicitly declared	Has BROWSABLE intent filter
PrivateActivity	false	Explicitly non-exported
SendingDataViaActionActivity	Not explicitly declared	No exported attribute
ResultActivity	true	Explicitly exported
InsecureShopProvider	true	Exported ContentProvider
FileProvider	false	Non-exported
UploadService	true	Exported service

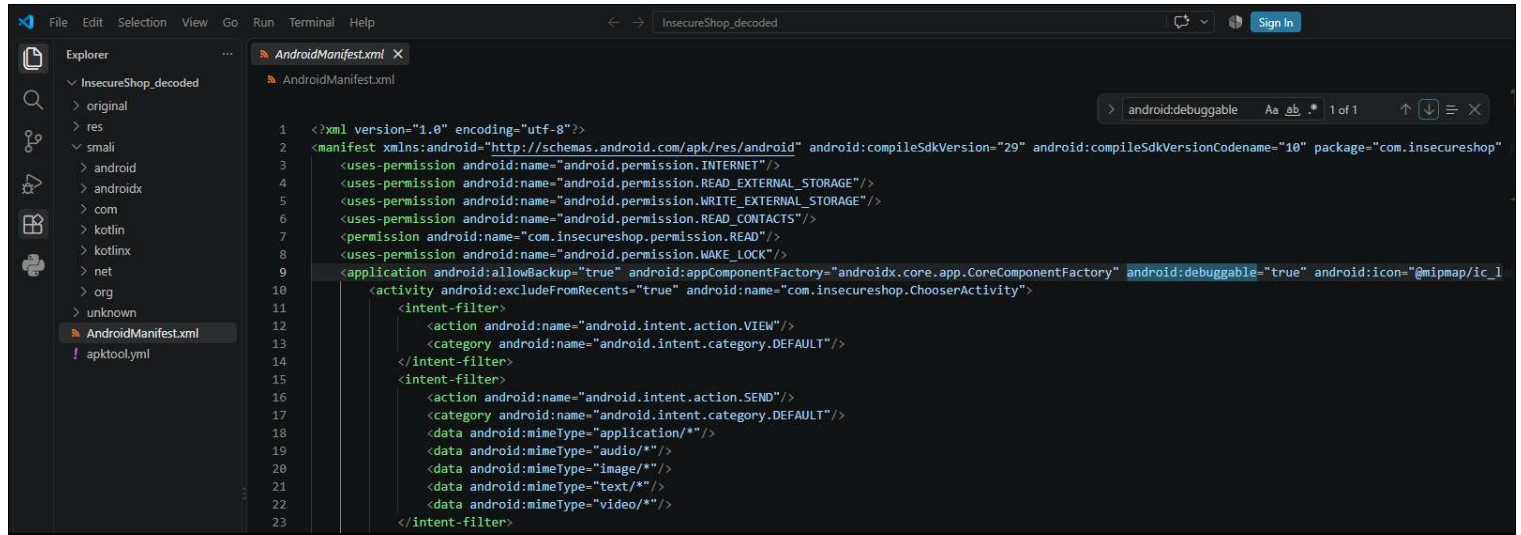
For components without an explicit `android:exported` attribute, this was not simply recorded as **false** – the effective behaviour can depend on Android version and intent-filter/component rules.

3. Permissions

The manifest declares: `android.permission.INTERNET`, `android.permission.READ_EXTERNAL_STORAGE`, `android.permission.WRITE_EXTERNAL_STORAGE`, `android.permission.READ_CONTACTS`, `android.permission.WAKE_LOCK`, and a custom `com.insecureshop.permission.READ` permission, which is also used as the `android:readPermission` on the exported provider.

Screenshot 1

Decoded AndroidManifest.xml with android:allowBackup highlighted.



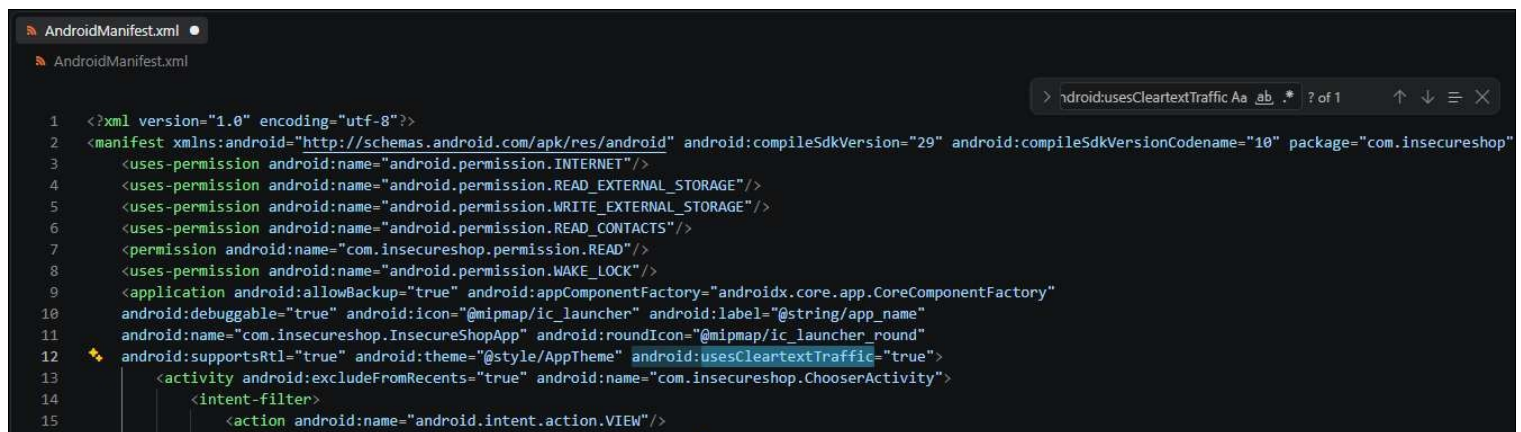
Screenshot 2

Decoded AndroidManifest.xml showing android:debuggable and other application-level flags.



Screenshot 3

Decoded AndroidManifest.xml with android:usesCleartextTraffic highlighted.



Screenshot 4

Decoded AndroidManifest.xml, further view confirming the usesCleartextTraffic setting.

```
1  <?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
2  <manifest xmlns:android="http://schemas.android.com/apk/res/android" android:compileSdkVersion="29" android:compileSdkVersionCodename="10"
3      <uses-permission android:name="android.permission.INTERNET"/>
4      <uses-permission android:name="android.permission.READ_EXTERNAL_STORAGE"/>
5      <uses-permission android:name="android.permission.WRITE_EXTERNAL_STORAGE"/>
6      <uses-permission android:name="android.permission.READ_CONTACTS"/>
7      <permission android:name="com.insecureshop.permission.READ"/>
8      <uses-permission android:name="android.permission.WAKE_LOCK"/>
9      <application android:allowBackup="true" android:appComponentFactory="androidx.core.app.CoreComponentFactory"
10         android:debuggable="true" android:icon="@mipmap/ic_launcher" android:label="@string/app_name"
11         android:name="com.insecureshop.InsecureShopApp" android:roundIcon="@mipmap/ic_launcher_round"
12         android:supportsRtl="true" android:theme="@style/AppTheme" android:usesCleartextTraffic="true">
13         <activity android:excludeFromRecents="true" android:name="com.insecureshop.ChooserActivity">
14             <intent-filter>
15                 <action android:name="android.intent.action.VIEW"/>
16                 <category android:name="android.intent.category.DEFAULT"/>
17             </intent-filter>
```

Task 5 – Deep Links and WebView Configuration

Objective: To review the manifest and JADX source for custom URI schemes/deep links and risky WebView configuration.

Item	Observation
Scheme	insecureshop
Host	com.insecureshop
Component	WebViewActivity
WebView component	WebView2Activity

WebView findings

Configuration	Observation
setJavaScriptEnabled(true)	JavaScript enabled
setAllowUniversalAccessFromFileURLs(true)	Universal access from file URLs enabled
loadUrl()	URL can be obtained from Intent data/query parameter/extras

Observation: The application defines a custom `insecureshop://` URI scheme. `WebView2Activity` enables JavaScript and universal access from file URLs. It also passes URL values obtained from incoming Intent data, query parameters, or extras directly to `WebView.loadUrl()`. These findings are security-relevant and require further validation; they are not treated as confirmed vulnerabilities based solely on static analysis.

Screenshot

WebView2Activity source in JADX showing setJavaScriptEnabled, setAllowUniversalAccessFromFileURLs, and loadUrl() reading data from the incoming Intent.

Find: loadUrl

```

12     return this.USER_AGENT;
13 }

14 @Override // androidx.appcompat.app.AppCompatActivity, androidx.fragment.app.FragmentActivity, androidx.act
15 protected void onCreate(Bundle savedInstanceState) {
16     super.onCreate(savedInstanceState);
17     setContentView(R.layout.activity_webview);
18     setSupportActionBar((Toolbar) _$.findCachedViewById(R.id.toolbar));
19     setTitle(getString(R.string.webview));
20     Intent extraIntent = (Intent) getIntent().getParcelableExtra("extra_intent");
21     if (extraIntent != null) {
22         startActivity(extraIntent);
23         finish();
24         return;
25     }
26
27     WebView webview = (WebView) findViewById(R.id.webview);
28     Intrinsic.checkExpressionValueIsNotNull(webview, "webview");
29     WebSettings settings = webview.getSettings();
30     Intrinsic.checkExpressionValueIsNotNull(settings, "webview.settings");
31     boolean z = true;
32     settings.setJavaScriptEnabled(true);
33     WebSettings settings2 = webview.getSettings();
34     Intrinsic.checkExpressionValueIsNotNull(settings2, "webview.settings");
35     settings2.setLoadWithOverviewMode(true);
36     WebSettings settings3 = webview.getSettings();
37     Intrinsic.checkExpressionValueIsNotNull(settings3, "webview.settings");
38     settings3.setUseWideViewPort(true);
39     WebSettings settings4 = webview.getSettings();
40     Intrinsic.checkExpressionValueIsNotNull(settings4, "webview.settings");
41     settings4.setAllowUniversalAccessFromFileURLs(true);
42     WebSettings settings5 = webview.getSettings();
43     Intrinsic.checkExpressionValueIsNotNull(settings5, "webview.settings");
44     settings5.setUserAgentString(this.USER_AGENT);
45     Intent intent = getIntent();
46     Intrinsic.checkExpressionValueIsNotNull(intent, "intent");
47     String dataString = intent.getDataString();
48     if (!(dataString == null || StringsKt.isBlank(dataString))) {
49         Intent intent2 = getIntent();
50         Intrinsic.checkExpressionValueIsNotNull(intent2, "intent");
51         webview.loadUrl(intent2.getDataString());
52         return;
53     }
54
55     Intent intent3 = getIntent();
56     Intrinsic.checkExpressionValueIsNotNull(intent3, "intent");
57     Uri data = intent3.getData();
58     String queryParameter = data != null ? data.getQueryParameter("url") : null;
59     if (!(queryParameter == null || StringsKt.isBlank(queryParameter))) {

```

Task 6 – Resources and Assets Review

Objective: To review decoded resource and asset files for hardcoded sensitive values such as passwords, tokens, secrets, API keys, server URLs, or encryption keys.

The decoded application resources were reviewed for passwords, tokens, secrets, API keys, encryption keys, and server URLs. In `res/values/strings.xml`, an AWS Cognito Identity Pool ID was observed: `us-east-1:7e9426f7-42af-4717-8689-00a9a4b65c1c`. This value is an identifier and was not treated as a confirmed secret. The `res/xml`, `res/raw`, and `assets` directories were not present in the decoded application. No confirmed passwords, authentication tokens, or encryption keys were identified during this resource review.

Location	Finding	Assessment
res/values/strings.xml	AWS Cognito Identity Pool ID	Identifier; not treated as a confirmed secret
res/xml	Not present	No matching output observed
res/raw	Not present	No matching output observed
assets	Not present	No matching output observed

Screenshot

strings.xml showing the hardcoded AWS Cognito Identity Pool ID.



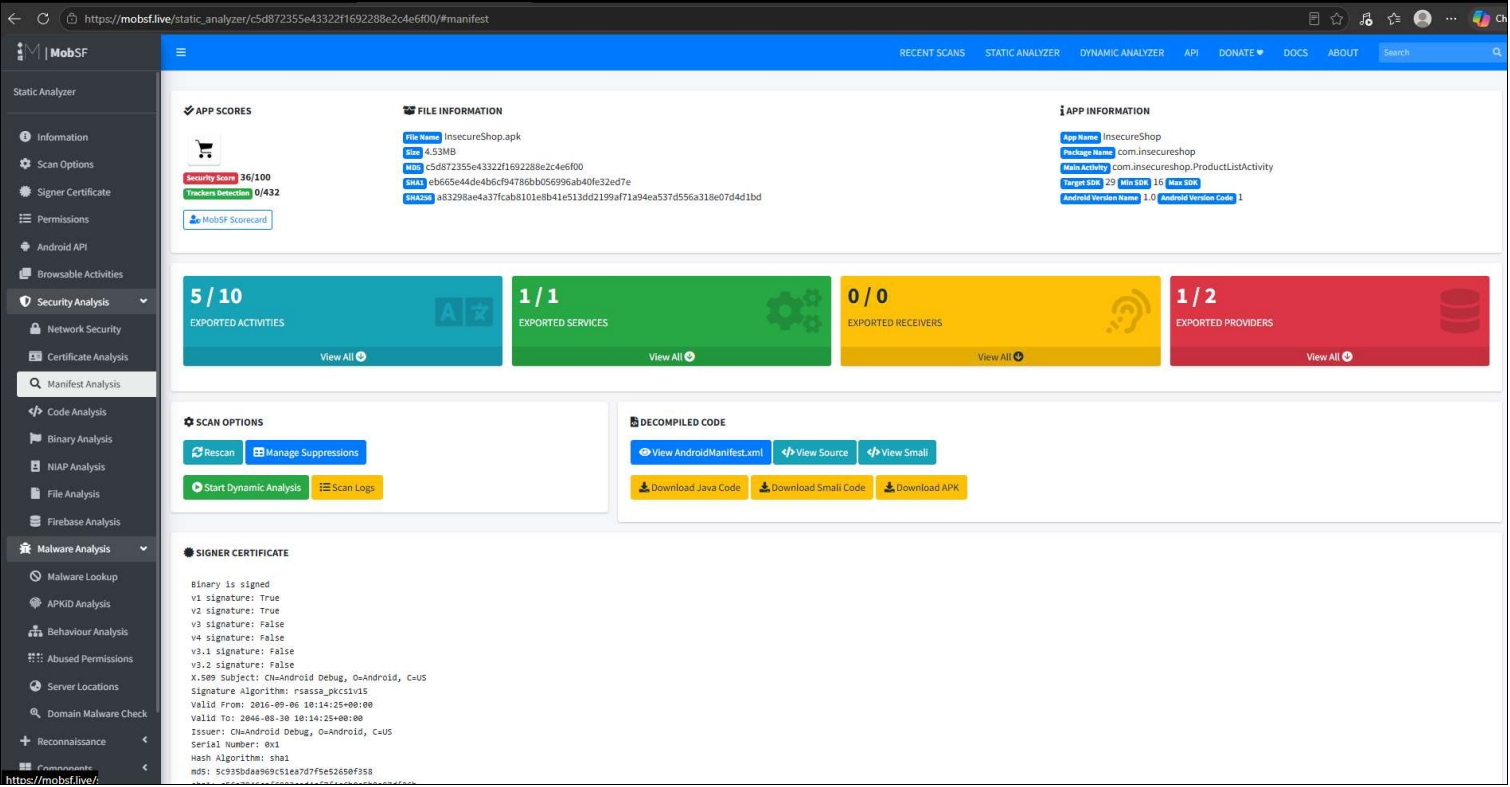
Part B – Automated Cross-Check (MobSF)

Task 8 – MobSF Scan

Objective: To scan the target APK using MobSF and record the overall security score along with one manifest-related and one code-related finding.

Screenshot 1

MobSF application overview showing the overall security score and file/app information.



Manifest finding

MobSF Finding	Severity	Evidence
Clear text traffic is enabled (<code>android:usesCleartextTraffic=true</code>)	High	AndroidManifest.xml

Screenshot 2

MobSF Manifest Analysis table identifying cleartext traffic enabled.

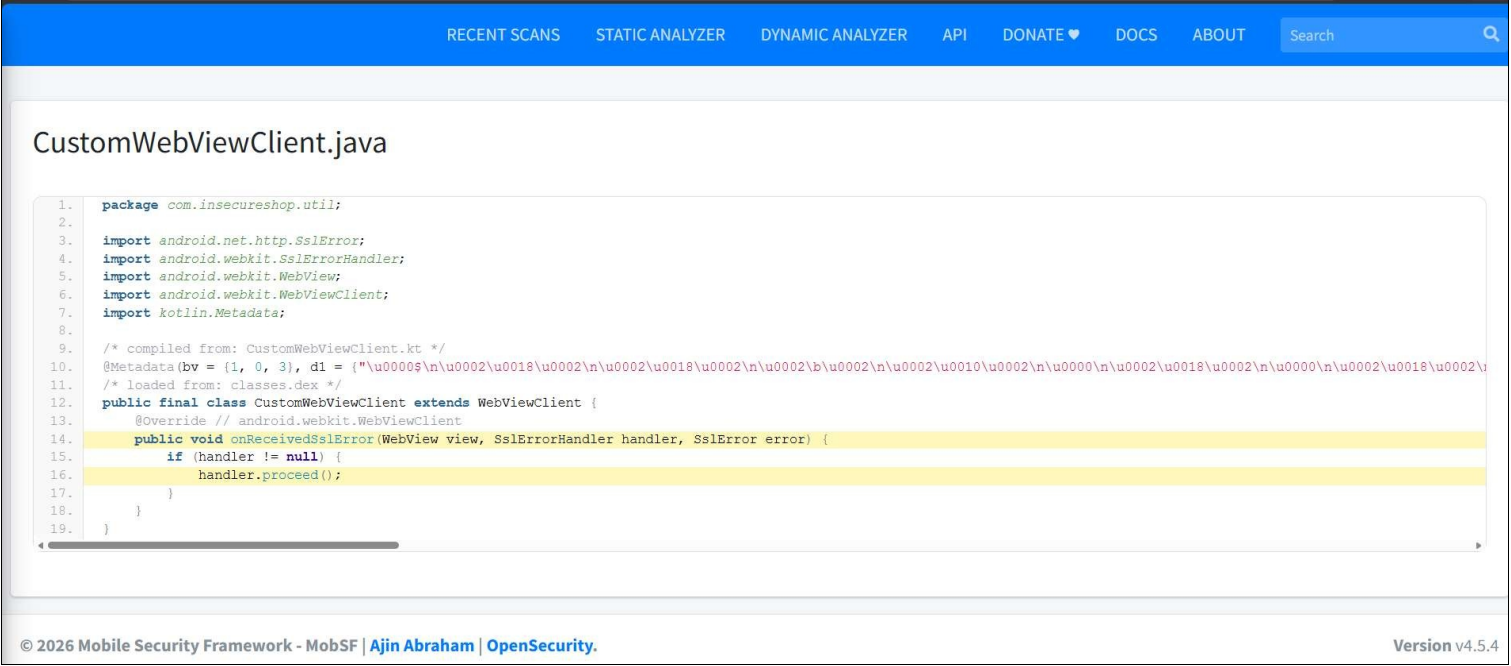
Task 9 – MobSF Cross-Verification

Objective: To compare MobSF findings against manual evidence gathered in Part A and mark each as verified, not verified, or a false positive.

MobSF Finding	Manual Evidence	Status
Cleartext traffic enabled (<code>android:usesCleartextTraffic=true</code>)	<code>AndroidManifest.xml</code> contains <code>android:usesCleartextTraffic="true"</code>	Verified
Insecure WebView SSL certificate validation	<code>CustomWebViewClient.java</code> overrides <code>onReceivedSslError()</code> and calls <code>handler.proceed()</code>	Verified

Screenshot

Manual verification of CustomWebViewClient.java, confirming SSL errors are bypassed via handler.proceed().



Conclusion

The static analysis of InsecureShop.apk showed that its most significant security-relevant observation is the combination of cleartext network traffic and an insecure WebView SSL implementation. MobSF flagged `android:usesCleartextTraffic="true"` as High severity, and this was manually confirmed in the decoded `AndroidManifest.xml`. More critically, `CustomWebViewClient.java` overrides `onReceivedSslError()` and unconditionally calls `handler.proceed()`, meaning the app accepts any SSL certificate, including invalid or attacker-controlled ones. Combined with cleartext traffic being permitted and a WebView that loads URLs supplied through an external Intent, this creates a realistic man-in-the-middle risk: an attacker on the same network could intercept or inject traffic loaded inside the WebView. Additional supporting observations, such as the password being written to Android logs in `LoginActivity` and the exported `InsecureShopProvider` returning stored credentials, further indicate weak handling of sensitive data. Both key MobSF alerts were manually verified against source and manifest evidence rather than accepted at face value, in line with the assignment's verification requirement.